mass of the nation-state. It encompasses the Buddhist, Jain, Sikh, Muslim, Christian and Vedic religions.

'Bharat', whether it originated from Dasaratha's Kshatriya dynasty in the Ramayana or Dushyanta's Kshatriya dynasty of the Mahabharata, has its roots in male dynastic upper-caste rulers. Why should it be acceptable to women, apart from Shudras/ Dalits/ Adivasis, who all have problems with the Kshatriyaness of the name? It symbolises monarchical brute power, not our ancient republican heritage.

The Indus civilisation, from which the name India emerged through several—Greek, Latin, Persian etc.—twists and turns, reflects collective labour power, as well as the science and technology devised by our ancestors from pre-patriarchal Vedic times. The Indus source is a secular one; it does not hark back to our religious/ caste roots.

If colonial use of 'India' is the main cause for changing it, the term 'Hinduism', which was popularised and used widely in colonial times, also needs to be dropped. Before colonialism, all extant records have 'Hindoo' or 'Hindu', while the Brahmanical religion was referred to as 'Sanatan Dharma'. Muslim rulers and the East India Company coined 'Hinduism' to mean the Sanatan Dharma. The name Hinduism for that religion did not exist in any written text—either in Sanskrit or regional languages—before Muslim and British rulers used it. Muslim rulers did not use 'India', but the name Hindustan. That name incorporates both religion ('Hindu') and land ('*sthaan*').

The use of 'Hinduism' should thus be relinquished by the RSS/ BJP forces to oppose both Muslim and British rule. An ideal nationalist name for their religion could be 'Sanatan'. Then the Shudras/ Dalits/ Adivasis can draw a clear line between them and Sanatans. The concept of Sanatan stands for *varna dharma*. Dr Ambedkar and E.V. Ramasamy 'Periyar' have written about the close ties between caste and Sanatan Dharma.

The BJP in general and Narendra Modi in particular keep on attacking the dynastic rule of the Nehru family.

IF DYNASTIC RULE IS SUCH AN ANATHEMA TO MODI AND THE BJP, HOW COME THEY NOW WANT A **KSHATRIYA DYNASTIC NAME** FOR THE ENTIRE COUNTRY ITSELF?

How come the same BJP/ RSS forces now prefer a Kshatriya dynastic name for the country itself? The PM's aircraft already has 'Bharat' written in Hindi. The government used 'Bharat' at the G-20 summit. If the country's name is changed to Bharat during the Modi regime, all the PM's speeches against dynastic rule boil down to hypocrisy.

Ambedkar had an idea that a name like India shall reflect his vision where there should not be oppression of caste, religion, class or gender. He rejected many Sanatanists' demands in the Constituent Assembly that India should be named Bharat, not India. If 'India' is dropped by this government, Shudras/ Dalits/ Adivasis of India must oppose the move with all the might at their command. ■

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The G20 dinner invitation sent out by the President's office mentioned only Bharat (President of Bharat), and has fuelled a fierce debate. The nameplate in front of the Prime Minister at the G20 summit also proudly displayed the name Bharat instead of the usual India. Since the Constitution assures that India is Bharat, the President and the Prime Minister of Bharat are on the right side of protocol or rather erred on the right side. While the government is not offering any reasoning for the name change, the Opposition seems to have been caught on the wrong foot.

